

028. Chapter 3 Verses 4-6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.4

न कर्मणामनारम्भान्नैष्कर्म्यं पुरुषोऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥ ४ ॥

na karmaṇāmanārambhān
naiṣkarmyaṃ puruṣo'śnute |
na ca sannyasanādeva
siddhiṃ samadhigacchati ||

◆ na – not; karmaṇām – of actions; anārambhāt – from non-performance; ◆
naiṣkarmyam – freedom from action; puruṣaḥ – a man; aśnute – attains; ◆ na –
not; ca – and; sannyasanāt – from renunciation; eva – only; ◆ siddhim –
perfection; samadhigacchati – attains.

Man does not match the actionless state of Brahman by mere non-performance of work, nor does he attain perfection by renunciation only.

VERSE 3.5

न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥ ५ ॥

na hi kaścitkṣaṇamapi
jātu tiṣṭhatyakarmakṛt |
kāryate hyavaśaḥ karma
sarvaḥ prakṛtijairguṇaiḥ ||

◆ na – not; hi – indeed; kaścit – anyone; kṣaṇam – a moment; api – even; ◆ jātu – ever; tiṣṭhati – remains; akarma-kṛt – without performing action; ◆ kāryate – is made to do; hi – for; avaśaḥ – helplessly; karma – action; ◆ sarvaḥ – everyone; prakṛti-jaiḥ – born of nature; guṇaiḥ – by the Gunas (modes).

No one can live even for a moment without doing work.

Everyone without his will is made to do work by the qualities born of Prakriti.

VERSE 3.6

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥ ६ ॥

karmendriyāṇi saṁyamya
ya āste manasā smaran |
indriyārthānvimūḍhātmā
mithyācāraḥ sa ucyate ||

◆ karma-indriyāṇi – the organs of action; saṁyamya – restraining; ◆ yaḥ – who; āste – sits; manasā – with the mind; smaran – dwelling upon; ◆ indriya-arthān – objects of the senses; vimūḍha-ātmā – of deluded soul; ◆ mithyā-ācāraḥ – hypocrite; saḥ – he; ucyate – is called.

The man of deluded understanding who restraining the organs of the action sits contemplating the sense objects with the mind is called a hypocrite.